

YGGDRASIL

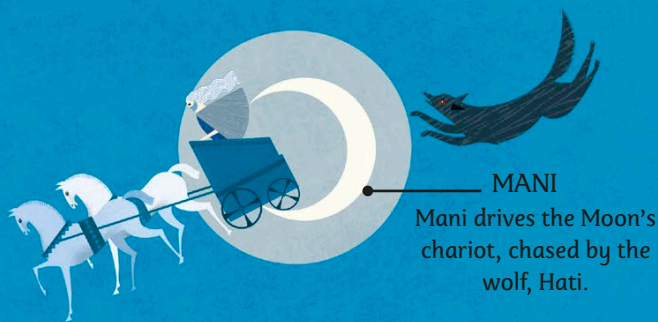
Through the centre of the Norse cosmos grows a mighty ash tree called Yggdrasil. It connects the Nine Worlds of the cosmos with swaying branches and twisting roots. Its snow-capped crown rises above the clouds, and dew slides from its leaves to fall on the valleys below. The Nine Worlds are home to different gods, creatures and people.

THREE WELLS

Yggdrasil is nourished through three roots fed by three wells. One root rises to the Well of Urd in Asgard, while another wends and winds to Mimir's Well in Jotunheim. The third root burrows deep into icy Niflheim. Here it connects to a well called Hvergelmir, which seethes and hisses like a boiling kettle.

TREE CREATURES

Many creatures live in Yggdrasil. A wise eagle perches in the topmost branches, and between its eyes sits a hawk. Four greedy stags devour leaves, not caring about the damage they cause. An evil dragon called Nidhogg gnaws at the tree's roots. Finally there's Ratatosk, a scampering squirrel who spreads lies between Nidhogg and the eagle.



MANI
Mani drives the Moon's chariot, chased by the wolf, Hati.

VANAHEIM

In the branches west of Asgard lies Vanaheim, home of the Vanir gods.



JÖRMUNGANDR
The World Serpent encircles Midgard.

ALFHEIM

The fair elves live in Alfheim.

NIDHOGG
This malicious dragon's name means "hateful striker".

RATATOSK
"Drill tooth" is a busy squirrel.

HVERGELMIR
Snakes and dragons live in this well.